Puru Vats

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EDUCATION

- **IDC School of Design, IIT Bombay** *07/2023 – 07/2027*
  Bachelor of Design (B.Des) CPI **9.01/10**

WORK EXPERIENCE

D.E. Shaw & Co. | Interaction Design Intern *05/2026 – 07/2026*

- Redesigned Iris (In-house data visualization tool) from an AI first perspective targeting chart creation, configuration and data discovery, simplified the tool by introducing a unified AI entry point, semantic search, and progressive disclosure patterns.
- Engineered a working prototype in Cursor across 4 weekly sprints and delivered final screens in Figma along with a multi-state component library, interaction logic and edge-case handling for async Human in the loop chart creation & edit workflows.
- Translated user research into multi-state interaction models and prompt-to-chart workflows, validating design decisions and refining edge cases through weekly feedback with product and engineering leads.

GE3S Sustainability Corporation | UI/UX Design Intern *01/2026 – 03/2026*

- Designed a unified enterprise portal consolidating 5+ in-house sustainability tools under a new visual identity; established platform-wide design tokens, navigation trees, and visual guidelines across disparate internal applications.
- Conducted a UX audit of data-entry form patterns, input validation states, and visitor onboarding flows; evaluated report generation views to establish content hierarchies, error recovery states, and progressive disclosure layouts.

Akai-Space | Product Design Intern *11/2024 – 03/2025*

- Designed a tool to track data labeling status with analytics, workflows, and collaboration tools to streamline client operations. Delivered UI component library for Akailon (Gamified Data Labelling), adding fun interactions to drive engagement and retention.

Placement Cell, IIT Bombay | Internship Coordinator *06/2025 – 04/2026*

- Coordinated internships for 2,000+ students with a 24-member team, streamlining communication and support, while building relationships with 250+ companies and 50+ global universities to secure opportunities representing IDC Department.

E-Cell & Mood Indigo, IIT Bombay | Design & Creatives Coordinator *08/2024 – 01/2025*

- Designed mobile and web experiences across campus such as E-Summit app (50K+ footfall), launched E-summit chapters portal (1K+ startups), and for Mood Indigo delivered the Soul-strings website and official print publication (125K+ reach).

PROJECTS

Ek-Time | UX Project *August 2025*

- Designed a Timetable management App for semi-urban schools in India to help teachers create, update and communicate the School Timetable asynchronously. Conducted Primary and Secondary research and designed an end to end Web and Mobile application reducing data input friction and streamlining substitute teacher allocation.

Strava App Re-Design | Visual Ergonomics *September 2025*

- Ergonomically evaluated Strava- fitness tracking app. Analyzed usability factors and redesigned the app improving time based efficiency & reduced cognitive load by ~64.45% of selected tasks. Evaluated using methods like HTA, SHERPA, SUS, NASA-TLX, Heuristic evaluation etc. to improve on activity logging, viewing statistics, navigating socials and sharing an activity.

Rapido X Airbnb | UX Project *March 2026*

- Redesigned the Rapido booking flow across the 5 Layers of UX through the lens of Airbnb's philosophy, implementing host-style Captain profiles and ride-vibe selectors to focus on user delight, trust and safety. Made a working prototype with narrative status updates providing visual reassurance, reducing wait anxiety and cancellation rates during the pickup phase.

ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Institute Academic Prize Awardee** (2 times) *2025 & 2026*
- Best Internship Coordinator Award *2026*

CO-CURRICULARS

- **Owner, Meejimo (Clothing Brand)**: Grew brand 0 to 3.2k+ followers, 3M+ impressions, 200+ items sold in 3 months.
- **DAMP Mentor**: Mentored 6+ design students in a 150+ team.
- **IMLP**: Taught keyboard to a batch of 50+ on campus.

SKILLS

- **Core Design**: UI/UX Design, Interaction Design, Design Systems, Information Architecture, Wireframing, AI Assisted Rapid Prototyping, Accessibility, Micro interactions.
- **Research & Evaluation**: Quantitative Research, Focus Groups, User Journey, Contextual Inquiry, Personas, Usability Testing, Heuristics, HTA, SHERPA, SUS, NASA-TLX.
- **Toolset**: Figma, Cursor.ai, Adobe Creative Suite, Framer, Spline, HTML, CSS, Java, Claude Code, Antigravity, Google Stitch, Tableau, PowerBI.